

Word family: **television / TV / television set / televise / televised / televising / televisual / telecast**

Base word: television

Common shortened form: TV

Related forms: televise, televised, televising

Useful family extensions: television set, televised, televisual, telecast

Common compounds: TV commercial, TV programme/program, TV series, TV show, TV station, TV channel, TV presenter/host, television industry

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞), with related verb/adjective forms

Your passage:

> “One advertisement that persuaded me to buy a product was a **TV commercial** for a pair of noise-cancelling headphones. I saw it about a year ago when I was watching **television** late at night after work.”

This is a nice example because the passage itself contains **TV** and **television** in slightly different constructions.

A semantic note first: **television** does not have a huge number of unrelated meanings. It has one central concept—the technology/medium of transmitting moving pictures and sound—but several important contextual meanings:

1. the **device**;
2. the **medium/system**;
3. the **programmes/content** shown through that medium;
4. the **television industry**.

We should keep those connected rather than inventing dozens of senses.

Meaning in your passage

There are actually **two relevant uses** here.

TV commercial

Here **TV** means:

television as a broadcasting/media platform

繁體中文: **透過電視媒體播放的**

> “a TV commercial”

= **電視廣告**

watching television

Here **television** means:

watching programmes/content broadcast or delivered through television

繁體中文: **看電視節目／觀看電視內容**

> “I was watching television.”

= **我當時正在看電視。*

It does not specifically mean:

> staring at the physical television set.

It means watching **content on television**.

1. **television / TV = electronic device (電器) — 電視機**

Meaning: The physical device with a screen used to display television programmes, video, etc.

Practice 1

> “We bought a new **television** for the living room.”

「我們為客廳買了一部新**電視機**。」

Practice 2

> “The **TV** is mounted on the wall.”

「**電視機**安裝在牆上。」

television / TV — device = 用來顯示電視節目、影片和其他影音內容的電子設備

In everyday English, **TV** is much more natural than saying **television set** repeatedly.

2. **television / TV = broadcasting medium/system (媒體／傳播方式) — 電視; 電視媒體**

Meaning: The system or medium through which moving pictures and sound are broadcast or distributed to viewers.

Practice 3

> “The event was shown live on **television**.”

「這項活動透過**電視**現場直播。」

Practice 4

> “Advertising on **TV** can reach a very large audience.”

「在**電視媒體**上投放廣告可以接觸大量觀眾。」

television / TV — medium = 以影音形式向大眾傳送節目和資訊的電視傳播媒體

This is the sense behind:

> **TV commercial**

because the commercial is made **for television as a medium**.

3. **television / TV = programmes/content collectively (節目內容) — 電視節目; 電視內容**

This is your second passage use.

Practice 5 — Original

> “I was watching **television** late at night.”

「我深夜正在**看電視／觀看電視節目**。」

Practice 6

> “There isn’t much good **TV** on tonight.”

「今晚沒有太多好看的**電視節目**。」

Practice 7

> “She watches very little **television**.”

「她很少**看電視節目**。」

television / TV — content = 透過電視平台播出的節目和影音內容的總稱

So:

> “I watch television.”

usually means:

我看電視節目

not:

我觀看那部電視機本身.

4. **television / TV = television industry (行業) — 電視業; 電視產業**

Meaning: The professional field involved in making, producing, broadcasting, and presenting television content.

Practice 8

> “She has worked in **television** for twenty years.”

「她在**電視行業**工作了二十年。」

Practice 9

> “He wants a career in **TV**.”

「他希望在**電視業**發展事業。」

television / TV — industry = 製作、演出、管理和播放電視內容的整個行業

Compare:

> “She works in television.”

= 她從事電視行業。

Not:

> 她在一部電視機裡工作。😊

5. **TV + noun (媒體／節目／職業) — 電視……; 與電視有關的……**

TV is extremely common before another noun.

Practice 10

> “It was a **TV commercial** for headphones.”

「那是一則耳機的**電視廣告**。」

Practice 11

> “She is a well-known **TV presenter**.”

「她是一位著名的**電視節目主持人**。」

Common combinations:

* **TV commercial** = 電視廣告

* **TV programme/program** = 電視節目

* **TV show** = 電視節目

* **TV series** = 電視劇／電視系列

* **TV channel** = 電視頻道

* **TV station** = 電視台

* **TV presenter** = 電視主持人

* **TV audience** = 電視觀眾

* **TV industry** = 電視產業

TV + noun = 與電視媒體、節目或產業有關的……

6. **television set = physical television device — 電視機**

This is the explicit full phrase for the device.

Practice 12

> “The hotel room has a large **television set**.”

「酒店房間裡有一部大型**電視機**。」

Practice 13

> “Older **television sets** were much heavier.”

「舊式**電視機**重得多。」

television set = 實體電視機

In everyday conversation:

> **TV**

is usually much more natural.

7. **televisе + event/programme** (事件／節目) — 電視轉播; 在電視上播放

This is the main verb in the family.

Meaning: To broadcast something on television.

Practice 14

> “The match will be **televised** live.”

「這場比賽將會**由電視現場直播**。」

Practice 15

> “The ceremony was **televised** around the world.”

「這場典禮透過電視向全球**轉播**。」

televisе = 透過電視媒體播放／轉播某項活動或內容

8. **televised** = shown/broadcast on television — 經電視播放的; 電視轉播的

Here, the past participle often functions adjectivally.

Practice 16

> “It was a **televised** debate.”

「那是一場**由電視轉播的辯論**。」

Practice 17

> “The event attracted a huge **televised audience**.”

「這項活動吸引了大量透過電視收看的**觀眾**。」

televised = 已被安排透過電視媒體播放／轉播的

9. **televising** = broadcasting something on television — 電視轉播; 播放

Practice 18

> “Several networks are **televising** the event.”

「幾家電視網絡都在**轉播這項活動**。」

Practice 19

> “The channel began **televising** the series last month.”

「這個頻道上個月開始**播放這套劇集**。」

televising = 正在透過電視播出某項內容

10. **televisual** = relating to the visual language/qualities of television — 電視媒體的; 具有電視視覺特性的

This is a real family member, but more **formal/academic**.

Practice 20

> “The programme has a distinctive **televisual** style.”

「這個節目具有獨特的**電視視覺風格**。」

Practice 21

> “The article examines modern **televisual** culture.”

「這篇文章研究現代**電視媒體文化**。」

televisual = 與電視這種視覺媒體的形式、風格或文化有關的

Register: media studies / academic / formal.

Useful for recognition, but not core everyday vocabulary.

11. **telecast = television broadcast / broadcast on television — 電視轉播; 電視廣播**

A useful family-extension word.

It can be a **noun** or **verb**.

Noun

> “The live **telecast** attracted millions of viewers.”

「這次現場**電視轉播**吸引了數百萬觀眾。」

Verb

> “The ceremony was **telecast** live.”

「典禮由電視**現場轉播**。」

telecast = 透過電視進行的廣播／轉播

It is somewhat more formal and less common in everyday conversation than:

> broadcast on TV

> televise

but still useful.

Important distinction: **TV vs television**

In most everyday contexts they mean the same thing.

TV

more conversational and compact.

> “I watch a lot of TV.”

television

slightly more formal/full.

> “Television has changed dramatically.”

In compounds, **TV** is extremely common:

> TV commercial

> TV show

> TV channel

Important distinction: **television vs television set**

television

can mean:

* the medium;

* the content;

* sometimes the physical device.

television set

specifically means:

the physical machine

> “Turn off the television set.”

= 關掉電視機。

Nowadays, simply **TV** is much more common.

Important distinction: **watch television** vs **watch the television**

This is subtle and useful.

**watch television / watch TV**

= watch television programmes/content

> “I watched TV all evening.”

「我整晚都在看電視節目。」

**watch the television**

can literally mean looking at **the particular television set**, though context may sometimes still make it mean watching what is on it.

For ordinary activity, English strongly prefers:

> **watch TV**

> **watch television**

without **the**.

Important distinction: **on TV** vs **on the TV**

**on TV**

= being broadcast/shown through television

> “I saw the advertisement on TV.”

「我在電視上看到那則廣告。」

**on the TV**

often means physically on top of / displayed on the particular television set depending on context.

> “The remote is on the TV.”

「遙控器在電視機上面。」

Or:

> “There’s a strange message on the TV.”

「那部電視螢幕上有一則奇怪訊息。」

So the article matters.

Important distinction: **TV programme/show vs TV series**

TV programme/program

broad term for an individual television production.

TV show

common conversational term.

TV series

a programme consisting of multiple connected episodes.

A news broadcast can be a **TV programme**, but normally not a **TV series** in the same sense.

Important distinction: **television vs video**

television

refers to the medium/platform/programming tradition.

video

refers broadly to recorded or transmitted moving visual content.

A YouTube clip is:

> a video

but not necessarily:

> television

This distinction has become especially relevant in modern media.

Important distinction: **television** vs **broadcast**

television

= medium

broadcast

= transmission of audio/video to an audience; can be TV, radio, etc.

> “The programme was broadcast on television.”

「節目透過電視播放。」

So:

broadcast is broader than **television**.

Countability note

Medium/activity — usually uncountable:

> “Television became popular in the twentieth century.”

「電視這種媒體在二十世紀普及。」

> “I watch television.”

「我看電視。」

Device — countable:

> “They own two televisions.”

「他們有兩部電視機。」

Though everyday English would usually say:

> “They own two TVs.”

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the genuinely useful modern family includes:

- * **television — device** = 電視機
- * **television — medium** = 電視媒體／傳播方式
- * **television — content** = 電視節目／電視內容
- * **television — industry** = 電視產業
- * **TV** = television 的日常縮寫
- * **TV + noun** = 與電視有關的……
- * **television set** = 實體電視機
- * **televise** = 透過電視播出／轉播
- * **televised** = 經電視轉播的
- * **televising** = 正在進行電視播出
- * **televisual** = 與電視媒體形式／視覺文化相關的(較正式)
- * **telecast** = 電視轉播; 電視播放

Useful compounds:

- * **TV commercial** = 電視廣告
- * **TV show** = 電視節目
- * **TV series** = 電視系列／電視劇
- * **TV station** = 電視台
- * **TV channel** = 電視頻道
- * **TV presenter/host** = 電視主持人
- * **TV audience** = 電視觀眾
- * **television industry** = 電視產業

There are more historical/technical **tele-** formations, but they would add little value for this lesson, so I would stop here.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
television / TV — device	用來顯示節目、影片和其他影音內容的實體電子設備／電視機
television / TV — medium	向大眾傳送影音節目和資訊的電視傳播媒體／系統
television / TV — content	透過電視平台播放的節目和影音內容的總稱
television / TV — industry	製作、演出、管理和播放電視內容的整個行業
TV + noun	與電視媒體、節目或產業相關的.....
television set	實體的電視接收／顯示裝置
televisе	把活動、節目或事件透過電視播放／轉播
televised	已被安排或實際透過電視播放／轉播的
televisual	與電視媒體的視覺形式、風格或文化有關的
telecast — noun	一次電視廣播／轉播
telecast — verb	透過電視把內容播放給觀眾

For your original passage

You actually have two slightly different applications:

> “a ****TV commercial****...”

Here:

****TV = 電視媒體／電視平台****

so:

****TV commercial = 電視廣告****

Then:

> “I was watching ****television**** late at night...”

Here:

****television = 電視節目／電視內容****

So:

> ****watching television****

= ****看電視／觀看電視節目****

—not literally「觀看那部電視機」.